

The Global Impact of Generative AI on the HCI Landscape: International Perspectives on HCI Education, Industry Dynamics, and Funding Considerations

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Abstract

In recent years, we have witnessed a boom of AI-related research from both academia and industry at CHI. Built upon these ongoing conversations and a recent panel at CSCW 2025, this panel aims to promote community-wide discussions that reflect on generative AI's multidimensional impact on the global HCI landscape beyond specific research agendas or directions. In particular, rather than discussing such impact at the regional or even national level, we will highlight international perspectives on AI's impact on HCI education, industry dynamics, and funding considerations across various cultures and regions. Featuring a diverse group of panelists, including academic leaders in HCI education and industry experts from various regions, this panel aims to foster collective reflection at CHI on key questions crucial to sustaining the future of HCI as an international community.

CCS Concepts

• **Human-centered computing** → **Collaborative and social computing**; **Human computer interaction (HCI)**.

Keywords

generative AI, human-centered AI, HCI education, funding, international collaboration, industry perspectives

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1 Introduction

Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) systems (e.g., ChatGPT and Midjourney) are trained on large datasets and can generate music, text, videos, art, and designs that are similar to what humans could create based on learned and reproduced patterns from the training datasets [18, 29]. In the recent years, there is a growing trend to use these systems in various aspects of our daily lives, ranging from medicine and health care [21], learning and education [1], creative writing [9], and software/game development [23, 32, 34] to even online emotional support [2, 24]. These new phenomena have led to a boom in AI-related research at CHI from both academia and industry to investigate how these powerful technological advances continue to not only significantly shape people's work and social lives but also further complicate some of the deepest and most intimate human experiences (e.g., AI as a companion).

Indeed, we have seen an increasing number of CHI publications on various generative AI-related topics. Some recent examples at CHI 2025 include: AI for productivity support and knowledge/creative work (e.g., AI for writing, AI-enhanced craft, and AI-powered developer tools [25, 31, 33, 35]), human-centered AI design [16, 26], AI as an HCI research tool [37], AI for disadvantaged and/or marginalized users [4, 30], AI as emotional and social agents



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[3, 6, 15], ethical and moral risks of AI [11, 13, 36], among others. There were also numerous workshops, courses, and panels at CHI 2025 aimed to explore the intersection of AI and various existing HCI research agendas, such as generative AI and accessibility [8], generative AI and creative work [12], and so forth. Furthermore, researchers have reflected upon how generative AI may even expand the scope of HCI research [22], similar to the CSCW 2024 panel "Is Human-AI Interaction CSCW?" [20].

Built upon these ongoing conversations and our recent panel at CSCW 2025 [5], this panel aims to promote community-wide discussions that reflect on generative AI's multidimensional impact on the global HCI landscape, which extends beyond regional or even national levels. It also goes beyond merely discussing how generative AI is shaping specific HCI research directions. Such impact may include: how we as an international research community train and educate our next generation of HCI researchers in the age of generative AI, how generative AI is affecting the global tech industry trajectories and our students' future job prospects, how we can better approach international academia-industry collaboration to deal with such impacts, and how the growing focus on generative AI may (re)shape funding opportunities for future HCI research worldwide.

Ultimately, HCI as an international community must ask: *What is next? How can we coordinate and involve HCI communities across different regions to collaboratively prepare our community members, including students and early career researchers, for the AI era and the potential post-AI era?* Featuring a diverse group of panelists, including academic leaders in HCI education and industry experts from various regions, this panel aims to promote collective reflections at CHI on these key questions that are crucial for sustaining the future of HCI as an international community.

2 Panel Themes and Goals

In this panel, we aim to discuss important questions and considerations about generative AI's multidimensional impact on the global HCI landscape that go beyond specific research agendas or directions. In particular, rather than discussing such impact at the regional or even national level, we will highlight international perspectives on AI's impact on HCI education, industry dynamics, and funding considerations across various cultures and regions. We will focus on the following topics and example questions in this panel.

How should we, as an international research community, train and educate our next generation of HCI researchers in the age of generative AI? There have been growing discussions surrounding generative AI's impacts on both computer science education (e.g., teaching coding and programming [17]) and HCI education, such as using generative AI tools to generate synthetic HCI research data [10], help students understand HCI theories and principles [14], and facilitate the ideation and rapid prototyping phase of interactive device design [27], among others. Still, what is lacking is a comprehensive image of how we as an international research community should train and educate our next generation of HCI researchers in the age of generative AI, which include but is not limited to: curriculum development across different regions, methodology training, research skills and ethics, career trajectories,

and international exchanges and collaboration between different institutions and regions regarding HCI training and education.

Some example questions we will discuss in this panel are: *How are HCI educators in different regions currently approaching HCI education in the age of generative AI? What should HCI academic programs in higher education institutions across various regions do to help our students gain new skills and knowledge in the age of generative AI? What should HCI academic programs in higher education institutions across various regions do to also help faculty and early career researchers build their research agenda, seek funding, and train students in the age of generative AI? What can we do to facilitate international coordination, exchanges, and collaboration to facilitate such training and education?*

How is generative AI affecting tech industry trajectories and academia-industry collaboration in HCI in various regions? Since OpenAI's release of ChatGPT in November 2022, Generative AI has continued to transform the tech industry all over the world. Almost all tech giants, including Microsoft, Google, Apple, and Meta, are competing to develop their own generative AI systems and implement them in their own products (e.g., Microsoft's Copilot¹, Google Gemini², Apple Intelligence³, and Meta AI⁴). Along with the current boom in generative AI in the tech industry, the need for more powerful hardware, greater processing capacity, access to even larger training datasets and data centers, and new infrastructure supporting these advanced systems is also accelerating [19]. With rapidly rising costs to implement generative AI and keep pace with the heated AI competition in the tech industry, how this shift in priority and focus may affect HCI graduates' job prospects in industry and future academia-industry collaboration in HCI is a key concern. It is also critical to explore how such concerns and impacts may vary and evolve in different regions given specific local socioeconomic situations.

As such, some example questions we will discuss in this panel are: *How would the recent AI boom affect HCI students' job prospects in the tech industry? What are some new expectations for HCI graduates who seek industry jobs due to AI? How would the recent AI boom affect future academia-industry collaboration in HCI? How, if at all, do these above-mentioned impacts on students' job prospects and academia-industry collaboration also vary across different regions and economies? What would be the best methods and approaches to facilitate academia-industry collaboration within the global HCI community in the age of generative AI?*

How might the growing focus on generative AI (re)shape funding opportunities for HCI researchers worldwide? The recent AI boom is also reflected in the changing landscape of funding opportunities for HCI researchers, as various countries have highlighted AI design, development, and policy-making as one of their national priorities. For example, the European Union has developed the AI Act. It is the world's first comprehensive AI law, which directly regulates how AI would be used in Europe and funding

¹<https://copilot.microsoft.com/>

²<https://gemini.google.com>

³<https://www.apple.com/apple-intelligence/>

⁴<https://www.meta.ai/>

decisions regarding AI research⁵. The National Science and Technology Council in the USA considers AI “one of the most powerful technologies of our time” [28]. The National Science Foundation in the USA has invested in foundational artificial intelligence research since the early 1960s, which has also emphasized the need for advancing responsible AI systems as a national priority to serve the public good, such as leveraging AI to address societal challenges rather than introducing new ethical, legal, and social risks⁶. Some example questions we will discuss in this panel are: *What would be some new expectations for HCI researchers who plan to seek government funding to support their research on generative AI? What would be some new expectations for HCI researchers who plan to seek industry funding to support their research on generative AI? How, if at all, do these above-mentioned new expectations also vary across different regions and economies? What can we do to help HCI researchers seek funding to support international collaboration on AI research?*

Lastly, despite the high expectations and massive investments in generative AI nowadays, a crucial question arises: *“Are We in an AI Bubble?”*⁷ Some experts even predict that the current AI bubble may burst as early as 2025⁸. Therefore, we will end this panel by discussing: *What is next? How can we coordinate and involve HCI communities across different regions to collaboratively prepare our community members, including students and early career researchers, for the AI era and the potential post-AI era?*

The panel format will alternate between the moderator posing questions to the panelists, taking questions from the audience, and posing questions to the audience, to gather diverse community opinions and ensure the panel is accessible to all participants.

3 Organizers and Panelists

This panel involves two organizers/moderators and seven panelists. Although this panel involves more than five panelists, it is important and necessary to feature this group because they collectively represent academic leadership, industry expertise, and geographical diversity. Their international perspectives and rich domain knowledge are crucial to achieving the panel’s key goal.

Specifically, the main organizer and moderator (Guo Freeman) has successfully organized and moderated two generative AI-related panels at ACM GROUP 2025 [7] and ACM CSCW 2025 [5], laying a solid foundation for making this panel another engaging and inspiring experience for the CHI audience. The second organizer and moderator (Cliff Lampe) participated in the two panels mentioned above as a panelist and is well positioned to help organize and moderate this panel.

Regarding the panelists, three are industry experts from tech giants that are the primary driving forces behind generative AI models (IBM, Microsoft, and Google). Their insights would be invaluable for understanding current AI industry dynamics and for approaching international academia-industry collaboration in AI research in HCI. One of them also represents the global south perspective (e.g., Brazil). Additionally, two panelists represent higher

ed leadership in HCI in the USA. One serves as dean of a computing college at a major US university (Elizabeth Mynatt), and one is a leading researcher in HCI and AI and served as the former CSCW Steering Committee chair (Karrie Karahalios). This panel also includes a leading HCI and AI researcher in Asia (Xiaojuan Ma) and a panelist who serves as head of HCI research at a major European university (Paweł W. Woźniak).

Taken together, this panel brings unique knowledge, international visions, and diverse expertise from academia and industry to this topic, which will inspire engaging and thought-provoking community-wide discussions at CHI. Below, we provide more details about each organizer’s and panelist’s background and expertise.

Guo Freeman (organizer and moderator) is an Associate Professor of Human-Centered Computing at Clemson University, USA. Her most recent research focuses on AI-based moderation to mitigate emergent harassment risks in social VR and the impact of generative AI on creative technology workers. She served as general chair for CHI PLAY 2024 and GROUP 2025 and is general chair for CSCW 2026. She is also a member of the CHI PLAY and GROUP Steering Committees.

Cliff Lampe (organizer and moderator) is a Professor and Associate Dean for Academic Affairs at the University of Michigan School of Information, USA. He also served as Chair of the CHI Steering Committee and is a member of the ACM SIGCHI Academy. His work has highlighted moderation in online spaces, the effects of harassment and disinformation in online spaces, and recently, the motivations behind harassers in these spaces.

Elizabeth Mynatt (panelist) is a professor and Dean of the Khoury College of Computer Sciences at Northeastern University, USA. She is an ACM Fellow and a member of the American Academy of Arts and Sciences and the ACM SIGCHI Academy. Her work has focused on human-centered AI for supporting older adults.

Heloisa Candello (panelist) is a senior research scientist in the Responsible Tech group at the IBM Research laboratory, Brazil. She currently serves as an ACM Distinguished Speaker, chairs the SIGCHI LATAM committee, and is a member of the CHI Steering Committee. Her research focuses on the intersection of Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) and Artificial Intelligence (AI), particularly in evaluating challenges and risks associated with conversational AI systems.

Kori Inkpen (panelist) is a Partner Research Manager at Microsoft Research, leading the Future Experiences (FX) team. The FX team is focused on envisioning next-generation experiences that leverage emerging AI capabilities, including agents, generative user interfaces, and accessibility considerations.

Nitesh Goyal (panelist) leads Human-Centered Research at Google DeepMind about safety, leading to product launches with partners at public venues like Google I/O and award-winning research papers. His work has focused on using AI responsibly at scale to deliver safer outcomes in society for at-risk humans in domains such as content moderation, online hate and harassment, synthetic content production, and analytic tools. He is serving a second term as an ACM Distinguished Speaker and as a member of the CHI Steering Committee.

Karrie Karahalios (panelist) is a professor at the MIT Media Lab, USA. Her work focuses on designing experiences for people

⁵<https://www.europarl.europa.eu/topics/en/article/20230601STO93804/eu-ai-act-first-regulation-on-artificial-intelligence>

⁶<https://www.nsf.gov/focus-areas/artificial-intelligence>

⁷<https://money.usnews.com/investing/articles/are-we-in-an-ai-bubble>

⁸<https://www.forbes.com/sites/kolawolesamueladebayo/2025/01/20/experts-predict-the-bubble-may-burst-for-ai-in-2025/>

in our emerging algorithmic society—specifically around dignity, quality of AI experience/output over quantity, safety, diversity of thought, and autonomy. She also served as the CSCW Steering Committee chair.

Xiaojuan Ma (panelist) is an associate professor of Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) at the Department of Computer Science and Engineering (CSE), the Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (HKUST), Hong Kong SAR. She is particularly interested in Human-Engaged Computing (HEC) in domains, including but not limited to education, health, and design.

Paweł W. Woźniak (panelist) is a professor of human-computer interaction and head of the research unit at TU Wien, Austria. His research focuses on the intersection of technologies, sport, and well-being, exploring everyday experiences of physical activity and personal informatics to design technologies that support well-being.

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